CYBER SAFETY GUY

Chat Hour™

THE BASICS PARENTS NEED TO KNOW

Chat Hour is an online chat community and social networking app with public chat rooms, private messaging, user profiles and interest-based communities. It has been around since 1999 and connects people from all over the world.

ESTABLISHED SINCE 1999
Over 20 years of connecting people online

100K+ ANDROID DOWNLOADS
Popular social chat app
Google Play

16+/17+ AGE RATING
Mature content and interactions may be present
Google Play / App Store

CHAT ROOMS & MESSAGING
Public chat rooms, private messages & friend lists

WHAT IS CHAT HOUR?

Public Chat Rooms
Join thousands of chat rooms on all kinds of topics.

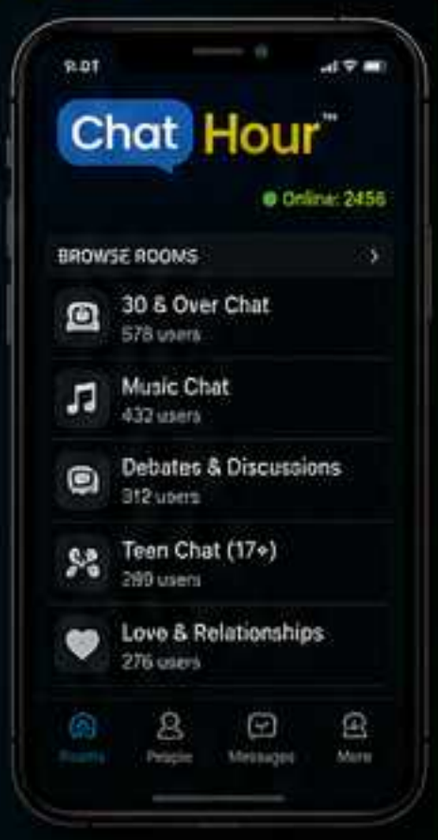
User Profiles
Create a profile, add photos, about me and interests.

Private Messaging
Send direct messages to other members.

Friend Lists
Add friends, follow users and keep in touch.

Interest-Based Chatting
Find rooms and people who share your interests.

Filters
Search and filter by location, age and gender.



Chat Hour is not just about one-to-one messaging. Public chat rooms are the heart of the app.

WHY YOUNG PEOPLE USE IT

Meet New People
Connect with people from around the world.

Join Interest Groups
Talk about music, gaming, relationships, sports, and more.

Chat Anonymously
You can join rooms and chat without revealing too much.

Make Online Friends
Build friendships and find people with similar interests.

Explore Communities
Huge variety of chat rooms on almost any topic.

It can feel fun, exciting and welcoming – especially if you feel lonely, bored or misunderstood.

RISKS PARENTS SHOULD KNOW

Adult Users
Many adults use Chat Hour. Not everyone is who they say they are.

Private Messages From Strangers
Private chats can move quickly and are harder to monitor.

Catfishing & Fake Profiles
People may lie about their age, looks, identity or intentions.

Scams & Grooming Risks
Some users may build trust to manipulate, exploit or harm young people.

Sexual Conversations
Mature or inappropriate language and themes can appear in chats.

Oversharing Personal Information
Sharing your location, school, photos or social media can put you at risk.

Once something is shared online, you lose control of it.

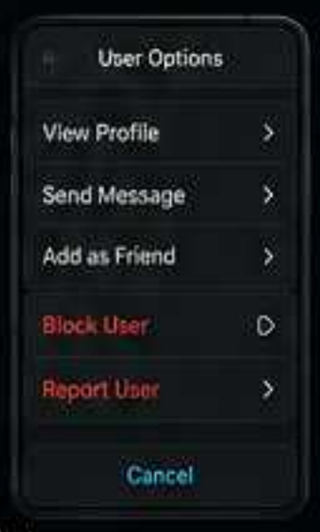
SAFETY FEATURES

Block Users
Block anyone who makes you uncomfortable.

Report Users
Report inappropriate behavior or content.

Profile Controls
Control who can message you and view your profile.

Chat Room Moderation
Rooms have moderators, but not all content is filtered.



Safety tools help, but they're not perfect. Parental awareness is key.

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1. **Most interactions are with strangers.** Even in "teen" or "17+" rooms, adults can join and share.
2. **Profiles can be fake.** Photos, age, location and interests can all be made up.
3. **Private messaging increases risk.** The more personal the conversation, the higher the potential danger.

Stay informed, stay involved and keep communication open.

CONVERSATION STARTERS

- What chat rooms do you like to use on Chat Hour?
- Do you know the people you are messaging?
- Has anyone ever said or done something that made you uncomfortable?
- What would you do if someone asked you to move the chat to another app or sent you something inappropriate?
- Can we look at your privacy together?



RED FLAGS TO WATCH FOR

- Spending large amounts of time in chat rooms
- Being secretive about who they are talking to
- New "online friends" they talk about a lot
- Someone asking for personal information, photos or social media
- Moving conversations off Chat Hour to another app or website
- Receiving gifts, money or special treatment
- Mood changes after chatting online

TIPS TO KEEP YOUR CHILD SAFE

- Talk regularly about online activity and online friends.
- Encourage your child to use public chat rooms, not private chats.
- Remind them to never share personal information or photos.
- Use strong privacy settings and block/report when needed.
- Encourage them to leave any chat that feels uncomfortable.
- Know that it's okay to talk to you about anything.
- Trust your instincts—if something feels off, it probably is.

QUICK DO'S

- Encourage open conversations.
- Know their online world.
- Use parental controls.
- Review privacy settings.
- Be a trusted place for help.

DON'TS

- Don't spy or snoop.
- Don't overreact—listen first.
- Don't shame or blame.
- Don't ignore problems.
- Don't dismiss their feelings.

WHERE TO GET HELP

Childline
0800 1111
childline.org.uk

The Mix
0808 808 4994
themix.org.uk

Internet Matters
internetmatters.org
Advice, guides and tools for parents

REMEMBER

Your involvement today helps your child make safer choices tomorrow.

NEED TO TALK? CHILDLINE 0800 1111

0800 1111
childline.org.uk

YOU ARE NOT ALONE
We're here for you.